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# TURKISH QUAGMIRE

John Kennedy was discussing the U-2 overflights of Cuba with the members of ExCom when Ted Sorensen, his legal counsel and speechwriter, silently handed him a news ticker tape. “Premier Khrushchev told President Kennedy yesterday,” read JFK aloud for the benefit of those present, “he would withdraw offensive weapons from Cuba if the United States withdrew its rockets from Turkey.” It was soon after 10:00 a.m. on Saturday, October 27.

The first to react to the news was McGeorge Bundy. “Hmm. He did not,” said the national security adviser. Sorensen defended himself, if not the accuracy of the news he had delivered: “That’s how it is read by both the associations that have put it out so far. Reuters has the same thing.” Bundy repeated his denial: “He did not!” Sorensen now expressed his own doubt: “He did not really say that, did he?” “No, no,” repeated Bundy. The news agencies referred to Khrushchev’s letter of “yesterday,” and Bundy remembered quite well that there had been no mention of Turkey in